



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 19

LOUISIANA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Louisiana's family courts and child-welfare system.

36

LOUISIANA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 64
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 27 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 26, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
16 OF 64

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

LOUISIANA AT A GLANCE.

Across 36 Louisiana families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 64 36 of 36 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$15,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 27 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 52.8% 30.6% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 36	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.8	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 36 of 36	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 16

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Louisiana families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF LOUISIANA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	23	\$15,000	\$67,630	\$1,555,500
Lost Wages	18	\$20,000	\$81,581	\$1,468,461
Other Court Fees	13	\$1,000	\$3,039	\$39,501
Therapy / Evaluations	18	\$1,750	\$6,238	\$112,291
Reunification Services	12	\$0	\$1,140	\$13,681
GAL Fees	14	\$0	\$1,857	\$26,001
Asset Loss ¹	16	\$52,500	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$90,250	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$52,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		27	2.2 yrs
Mean months lost		41	3.4 yrs
Total across all families		1,099	91.6 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · LOUISIANA

Most families documenting in Louisiana are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		17	47%
Not provided		13	36%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		3	8%
I am currently in an active case (progress is being made)		2	6%
Active case: progress being made		1	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		14	39%
Both Family Court and CPS		12	33%
Unknown		7	19%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		3	8%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		8	22%
3 – 5 years		7	19%
5 – 10 years		6	17%
1-3 years		5	14%
6 months – 1 year		4	11%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		12	33%
Children in Foster Care		8	22%
Visitation Only		8	22%
50/50 Joint		5	14%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		1	3%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Jefferson		3	8%
Ouachita		3	8%
Rapides		2	6%
Livingston		1	3%
Rapides Parish Alex La		1	3%
Jeff Davis Parish		1	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		10	28%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		7	19%
Other: (Short answer)		6	17%
High Conflict Divorce		2	6%
Judicial Abuse / Retaliation		2	6%

05 PARENT VOICES — LOUISIANA

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



Destroyed my faith in a fair legal system

— AMY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

EBR family court has. Profited off of Children's lives being sold here in Baton Rouge to the highest bidder ever since I was a child in this same system. Unethical, unconstitutional, no rights of due process, false imprisonment, deprivation of equal protection clause, civil [...]

— LOUISIANA PARENT · PRISCILLA

MORE VOICES FROM LOUISIANA

"What was supposed to protect my family instead fractured it—turning unproven allegations into real consequences for me and my children."

— PEPPER

Split us apart, brainwash and alienate my children. Destroyed a whole family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my marriage by painting us against each other and promising him ine things like custody and creating lies to start troubles. They dont want families together they want to destroy lives. Theres nonreunification. The system is designed one way. They win. And we are [...]

— LAUREN

This system has ripped my family apart. Now, I grieve the loss of my children while they are still living.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has destroyed my life, my family, and my income!

— STEVEN

Forced us to communicate with abuser making me feel like he still has control. The kids hate going to his home (our home) but he obviously owns more...

— CHASITY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Destroyed my family. Ruined our lives.

— LAUREN

Stole everything, my life, my sanity, my happiness.
Destroyed everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My life is numb. I'm lost. My soul is in constant pain. My family will never be whole again.

— ANGIE

Left me suicidal and wishing I could have taken matters in hand in the beginning and never gotten involved with the legal system. One or two good come to Jesus meetings and we all could have moved on happily.

— KELLY

I have experienced emotional, financial, legal, and mental abuse with coercive control over my child. More importantly my child has experienced emotional and mental abuse from the same situation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Make it make sense I can't make this shit yo if I tried

— NICOLE

It has casued me to lose custody of my son. An my marriage is coming to an end behind this as well.

— CHRISTINE

it has damn never killed me time I will never get back.
put stuff on me all most un respable to complete it's sad
sick it's a night near in my dreams at night scared to
enjoy life they watching trying to find something on me

— TIFFANY

The family has robbed my children not only of their mother and extended family, but their siblings. They've missed out on so much and have been nonstop brainwashed

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This beyond "cruel" situation, (instead) had "weaponized" our Injury Trial "Settlement", to deny my son his essential "continuing care", that he continued (for years) to be assured to receive, that suddenly instead has expedited his expiration date!

— RUSSELL

This system has beaten and destroyed the mental health of 6 very healthy people before them. I have had to watch my babies beg me to save them and couldn't do anything. My son is mad and blamed me for leaving because he doesn't understand. I went from 2 times a week visits to [...]

— TIFFANIE NICOLE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

My biological daughter was taken from me and placed with a non-biological caregiver. This case has devastated my life and my family. My youngest daughter has not seen her sister since she was a baby. I lost another pregnancy due to the extreme stress of this situation.

— ADREYON

The system is completely destroyed my life, my family and daughter. My ex picked up from school on April 17, 2023 and has never slept back in her home with me since then. She was four years old and I have missed every holiday and every school event because I cannot go. This is [...]

— BRITNEY

As the nonoffending parent, I was deprived of 10 years of a relationship with my son so he could be in Hidden Foster Care. He missed out on entire 1st, 2nd, and 3rd grades because the state did not ensure he was in school. It will have lifelong impacts.

— MICHAEL W.

22 Louisiana parents submitted ranked quotes. 22 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/la.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Louisiana report comes from Louisiana respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Louisiana — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 36 Louisiana families reporting here are not the universe of Louisiana families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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